



Happy New Year from all of us at International Canadian Schools



As we step into a new year, we step into new opportunities and the chance to reflect on all that we have experienced together. The start of a year is not just a turning of the calendar—it's a moment to celebrate achievements, learn from challenges, and imagine the possibilities ahead.

In this issue, you'll find stories that highlight the creativity, dedication, and energy of our school community. May 2026 be a year filled with growth, curiosity, and unforgettable moments. Let's approach every challenge with courage, every opportunity with enthusiasm, and every day with kindness. Happy New Year from all of us here at the ICS Journalism Club, and happy reading!

2025 Was the Year of IT at ICS

Our students are putting creativity, technology, and environmental awareness into practice! From 6A designing robots out of recycled materials to 2A coding their own virtual aquariums, innovation is everywhere. During Domestic Goods Week, 11th graders created business websites with QR codes, profit-loss calculations, and supporting documents, while Erasmus project students collaborated with visiting peers from Italy to design logos, program LEGO vehicles, and 3D-print souvenir keychains. Even everyday materials got a makeover—like turning shoe boxes into a fun basketball hoop!

Read more on pages 6 & 7.

Inspiring Studies in Science and Biology

As 2025 draws to a close, our students have transformed curiosity into hands-on learning. From exploring biology and biotechnology to traveling through the universe at the planetarium, they have combined experiments, projects, and international collaborations to connect knowledge with real life. Whether developing AI-supported solutions, participating in STEM challenges, or engaging in eTwinning projects, our students have grown as inquisitive, creative thinkers ready to explore, question, and shape the future.

Read more on pages 5 & 6.

A Major Revolution in Technology

In 2025, digital technology reshaped nearly every part of daily life. From AI becoming an everyday tool for work, learning, and creativity, to the rise of niche social networks and digital government services, the way we live, work, and interact has changed profoundly. Remote work, digital currencies, and AI-driven education systems challenged old norms, while questions about privacy, data security, and the human role in a digital world became more urgent than ever.

Read more on page 2.



A Major Revolution in Technology

by *Fatih Selçuk*

The year 2025 went down in history as a year in which digital transformation accelerated and began to directly affect nearly every aspect of daily life. From artificial intelligence to government services, and from social media to the world of work, profound changes took place across many areas.

The most notable development of the year was the widespread and routine adoption of artificial intelligence. AI tools in areas such as text writing, translation, image generation, and data analysis were no longer exclusive to specialists; they became everyday tools for ordinary users. Companies began to require employees not to reduce human labor, but to develop the skill of “working alongside AI.” This permanently changed job descriptions.

The digital labor market was also reshaped in 2025. As remote work

became permanent, the global freelance market expanded. A system in which workers from different countries competed for the same job became normalized. This, in particular, increased wage pressures in white-collar professions.

On the social media front, a major shift occurred. Traditional platforms lost users, while smaller, niche digital networks based on closed communities came to the fore. The psychological impact of algorithms became a more prominent topic of discussion; in some countries, restrictions on screen time and algorithms for young people were introduced into law.

2025 also became a year in which digital government applications became widespread. Identity verification, health records, taxes, and legal procedures began to be managed through a single digital

system in many countries. While this convenience was significant, it also sparked debates over data security and personal privacy.

Digital currency and payment systems underwent a significant transformation as well. As cash usage declined further, digital wallets and government-backed digital currencies became common in everyday life. At the same time, public concern grew over financial oversight and the control of personal spending data.

In education, digitalization deepened. AI-supported personalized learning systems became widespread, while traditional exams and assessment methods came under scrutiny. The role of the teacher shifted from knowledge transmitter to guide.

So, how will we protect humans and society in a digital world?

Hope: The New Year

by *Handan Akyel*

Each new year brings not only the aging of the calendar but also new hopes, new beginnings, and new joys. It's the day when the child within us, defying time, quietly and silently emerges from a corner of our souls even as the years pass...

The new year is the name for every smile, every small gift, every act of kindness, or simply making a wish without doing anything...

They say, “How you enter the new year is how it will go.” Sometimes it makes us smile, sometimes it makes us sad, but as we walk the thorny paths of life, even as the calendar pages fall one by one, we continue to grow older

Each year we bid farewell to with health is a new calendar, a sum of the moments we write on each page. With the power of a child's smile, with hope, joy,

peace, abundance, and prosperity, Welcome, New Year....





Nouvel an à travers le monde

by *Betül Sülün Deniz*

Le réveillon de la Saint Sylvestre est célébré la nuit du 31 décembre au 1er janvier pour la plupart des pays du monde.

Cette tradition date du début du XX^{ème} siècle. A cette occasion, les fêtes s'organisent souvent entre amis sauf dans certains pays comme le Japon ou la Russie où il est de tradition de rester en famille.

La façon de célébrer le passage à la nouvelle année est différente en fonction des pays, des religions, des coutumes, de la culture.

Quel pays changera d'année le premier ?

La Nouvelle Zélande, suivie de près par la ville de Sydney sont les premiers à célébrer la nouvelle année compte tenu du

fuseau horaire sur lequel ces pays se positionnent. Situés dans l'hémisphère sud c'est en plein été que le réveillon est célébré.

Les rituels des douze coups de minuit

- **On décompte** : 5, 4, 3, 2, 1.... BONNE ANNEE
- **On s'embrasse**, signe d'affection pour l'année à venir
- **On trinque** (dans les yeux surtout !!!)
- **On se souhaite le meilleur** : amour, santé, bonheur, réussite, argent...
- **On prend des résolutions** : arrêter de fumer, faire du sport, être moins ceci, plus cela...
- **On appelle ses proches** (enfin on essaye !)
- **On fait le bilan de l'année passée** (qu'elle est passée vite cette année !)

Les superstitions du jour de l'an

- **Pleurer** porterait malheur
- **Faire une tâche ménagère** entraînerait un décès
- **Dire des grossièretés** apporterait la malchance
- **Garder des objets de valeur** ferait fuir la chance

Les porte-bonheur : chance et prospérité

- **Remplir ses placards** et son portefeuille
- **Finir la bouteille**
- **Faire du bruit** : à l'origine les feux d'artifices, les cloches qui sonnent avaient pour but d'éloigner le diable
- **Recevoir un cadeau**

A Year in Which Uncertainty Becomes Permanent

by *Fatih Selçuk*

The year 2025 stood out as a year in which balances in world politics could not be reestablished and temporary solutions turned into lasting crises. In the international system, management and crisis control took precedence over stability.

The most notable feature of the year was the open and intense nature of great-power competition. The strategic rivalry between the U.S. and China was not limited to trade and technology; it extended to military, diplomatic, and ideological domains. The Taiwan

issue did not directly escalate into a conflict but remained at the center of world politics as a constant source of tension.

The Russia-Ukraine war in 2025 took on the character of a "hot but frozen" conflict. There were no major breakthroughs on the frontlines; however, the prolonged war increased economic fatigue in Europe. Differences of opinion over policies toward Russia became more visible within the European Union. While the Union maintained its claim to political unity, it

struggled to produce a common response in foreign policy.

The Middle East continued to be one of the centers of instability in 2025. Conflicts along the Israel-Palestine line did not escalate into a regional war, yet no lasting resolution emerged. Indirect competition persisted among Iran, the Gulf countries, and Israel. Regional politics was conducted more according to a logic of "controlled tension" than of actual solutions.

The ineffectiveness of multilateral



institutions was felt more clearly in 2025. The United Nations and similar organizations functioned more as record-keepers than crisis preventers. The structure of the Security Council and its veto system was once again debated, but no concrete reform steps were taken.

Global South countries, meanwhile, became more visible as political actors. Countries

in Africa, South Asia, and Latin America sought to create maneuvering space amid great-power competition. The non-alignment policy returned not as an ideological stance but as a pragmatic foreign policy choice.

2025 was also a year in which domestic politics strongly influenced foreign policy. In many countries, elections, economic crises, and social

polarization directly shaped foreign policy decisions. Populist rhetoric strained long-term diplomatic balances in pursuit of short-term gains.

In conclusion, 2025 was a year in which no new order was established in world politics, while the old order became clearly dysfunctional.

Looking Back on a Year, Stepping into the New Year with Hope

by Mesut Yilmaz

As we leave another academic year behind, it is of great importance to reflect together on what this period has brought us. The year we have completed has been a productive one, shaped by the collective efforts of our students, teachers, and parents, not only through academic achievements but also through the development of social, cultural, and human values.

Throughout this process, our students have been equipped not only with knowledge, but also with lifelong values such as

responsibility, cooperation, and self-discipline. The dedication of our teachers and the support of our parents have made significant contributions to strengthening our school climate.

Education gains its true meaning not only through outcomes, but through the effort devoted to the process itself. Every challenge we encountered over the past year has provided us with valuable experience, while every achievement has increased our motivation for the future.

As we enter the new year, we would like to reaffirm our determination to create a more qualified, safer, and more inclusive educational environment in line with our shared goals. Together with all our stakeholders, we will continue to support the academic and personal development of our students in the best possible way.

On this occasion, we wish the new year health, peace, and success for all our students, teachers, parents, and the entire education community.

İzmir Weather Forecast

for Wednesday, 31 December

Today in İzmir will be **cool and mostly cloudy**, with occasional **light rain or drizzle**, especially in the morning. Temperatures are expected to range between **4 °C in the early morning and around 10–12 °C in the afternoon**, making it a typical chilly winter day for the region.

Winds will be **light to moderate**,

generally from the **east or northeast at 10–20 km/h**, giving a noticeable but not harsh breeze.

Air pressure will remain **steady near 1010–1012 hPa**, reflecting fairly stable winter conditions with no major weather changes expected today.

In short, expect a **cool, partly**

cloudy day with light rain, gentle northeast winds, and normal winter air pressure throughout İzmir.





Inspiring Studies in Science and Biology

by *Gölsüm Söyler Öğretim*

On the last day of 2025, looking back on this fulfilling autumn semester, we are once again proud to see that our school is not just a place that teaches knowledge, but a learning environment that nurtures individuals who are curious, inquisitive, creative, and strive to better understand the world. Through experiments, projects, workshops, and scientific activities in science and biology, our students have succeeded in deciphering the language of nature, thinking scientifically, and connecting what they have learned to real life, and they will continue to do so until the end of the year.

Our school trip to the planetarium was an unforgettable scientific journey for our middle school students. In this journey of discovery into the fascinating world of stars, planets, and galaxies, our students had the opportunity to get to know the secrets of the universe up close; they reinforced their curiosity about space science, expanded their imaginations, and learned through experience that science continues beyond the classroom walls.

Within the scope of the ABE Türkiye program, we opened the doors to the future of science for 63 students by bringing innovations in the field of biotechnology into the classroom. Through activities focusing on DNA, genetic engineering, and biotechnological applications, our students had the opportunity to develop their scientific process skills, become familiar with laboratory culture,

and reinforce their theoretical knowledge through practical application. Thus, biology became not just a subject for them, but a field of discovery that opened up to understanding life itself.

Eight of our students have applied to the international STEM olympiad exams in science and will take the exam in February. Through these activities, which aim to foster analytical thinking, problem-solving, and an interdisciplinary perspective, our students have had the opportunity to test themselves in science, compete on a global scale, and gain scientific self-confidence. This process contributes to their preparation not only for the exams but also for the future of the scientific world.



Through eTwinning projects conducted at our school, our students experience science as a universal language by collaborating with peers from different countries. Having the opportunity to effectively use

digital tools, create collaborative products, and communicate across cultures, our students have taken significant steps towards becoming global citizens by developing both their academic and social skills. Thanks to these projects, our classrooms are transforming into scientific bridges opening up to all corners of the world.



Four of our high school students participated in the Green Catalyst Ideathon event at Katip Çelebi University, where they developed and successfully presented “AI-supported rational solutions in waste and water management.” This event significantly contributed to their development as individuals who not only think but also produce solutions.

Our middle and high school students had the opportunity to observe firsthand how scientific research and biotechnological applications are used in real life in agriculture through a trip to the Aegean Agricultural Research Institute. Receiving information



from experts on gene banks, tissue culture and beekeeping R&D studies, plant genetics, and sustainable agriculture studies, our students became more aware of the future of agriculture, food security, and environmental sustainability, and once again experienced firsthand the importance of biology in every aspect of life.

Following all these valuable studies, we will continue our scientific journey with the same enthusiasm and determination in the spring semester. Through new experiments, projects, trips, and international collaborations, we will continue to keep our students' curiosity alive and to raise them as individuals who question, produce, and shape the future. Among our planned activities, we aim to raise

awareness for our students about environmental consciousness, sustainable living, climate change, recycling, conservation of natural resources, and ecosystem balance through the "Necessary for the World" project, which we will carry out in partnership with the Habitat Association. Because we know that every step taken with science is a powerful light that illuminates our future.

2025 Was the Year of IT at ICS

by *Irmak Yılmaz Dakak*

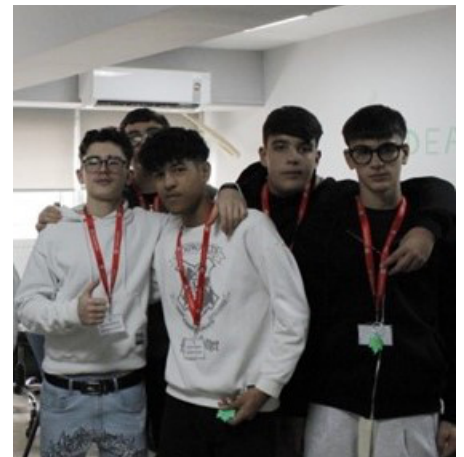
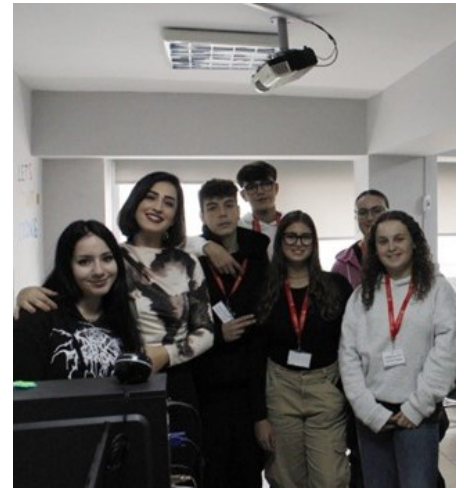
As part of a recycling and sustainability project, **6A students** designed robots using waste materials.



During Domestic Goods Week, **11th grade students** prepared and exhibited their websites, QR codes, and the necessary documents for opening a business at school as part of a local production and design project. With the support of the Information Technologies and Software course, they also added profit-loss and cost calculations to their websites.



As part of the *Erasmus* project, together with our students visiting from Italy, students designed their own logos using FMS logos in the software course. They did coding to operate vehicles they built with LEGO and created souvenir keychains using a 3D printer.





Technology, design, and recycling all together! We created a fun basketball hoop using shoe boxes.



2A students designed an aquarium by writing code with Scratch blocks. By doing this project,

they not only improved their programming skills, but they also developed their imaginations.



Pope Leo XIV: Modernizing the Vatican for the Digital Age

by Kyle Özel (9A)



When Pope Leo XIV was elected in May 2025, it was a massive shock. Being the first American Pope ever, he basically flipped the script on how things work at the Vatican. Instead of all the usual stiff, old-school ceremonies, he brought this super chill and relaxed energy. It's like the whole place finally exhaled. He's the kind of leader who feels like a real person you could actually talk to, which has made the Church feel way less like an ancient fortress and more like something that belongs in the modern world.

During his first year, he really focused on stuff that actually affects us—especially AI and new

tech. A lot of adults just tell us to put our phones away, but Leo XIV did the opposite. He told students that AI is a tool we should learn to master, not something to be afraid of. He's basically pushing for us to use technology to solve big problems and learn more, rather than just using it to zone out. It's pretty cool to see someone that powerful actually “get” the digital age and encourage us to be smart about it.

Now that we're moving into 2026, things feel different. There's this vibe of hope that hasn't been there in a long time. By mixing the old traditions with a fun, forward-thinking attitude, he's starting a new chapter that actually feels relevant to our generation. It's not just about rules anymore; it's about looking at the future and seeing all the possibilities. For the first time, it feels like the Vatican is actually moving at the same speed as the rest of the world.

This shift in perspective is also starting to change how the Church handles global connectivity and community building. Beyond just talking about AI, Leo XIV has begun greenlighting projects to create “digital parishes”—virtual spaces where young people from different continents can collaborate on social justice initiatives or environmental projects in real-time. By treating the internet as a mission field rather than a distraction, he's effectively dismantling the walls of the Vatican and rebuilding them as a global, digital hub. It feels less like we're being preached at from a distant balcony and more like we're part of a worldwide laboratory for good. As the year unfolds, the focus has shifted from “how do we survive the future?” to “how do we build it?”, making the faith feel like a proactive force for innovation rather than a relic of the past.



A Look Back at Cinema in 2025

by Yonca Turuşlar (11A)

The year 2025 went down in history as a very special year in the world of cinema, one in which both commercial successes and artistic experiments reached their peak simultaneously. From the very first days of the year, movie theaters began to fill up again, and audiences once more experienced the excitement of the big screen that they had long missed. The films released in January and February gave the first signs of how ambitious 2025 would be for cinema. Especially in the genres of science fiction, horror, and drama, films kept audiences engaged at the start of the year.

As spring arrived, the industry seemed to shift into a higher gear. Disney's *Snow White*, bringing a classic fairy tale to the big screen with a modern interpretation, created a huge buzz—not only through its visual world but also through its messages and new character depth. The film's success reignited interest in live-action adaptations and reinforced the strong position of family cinema in 2025.

One of the biggest events of this period was undoubtedly *Mission: Impossible – The Final Reckoning*. In this film, Tom Cruise bid farewell to his iconic Ethan Hunt character, and it was recognized as one of the productions representing the pinnacle of action cinema. The film not only broke box office records but also showcased the state of cinema technology with its stunt sequences, real-location shoots, and high-paced action. Around the same time, the live-

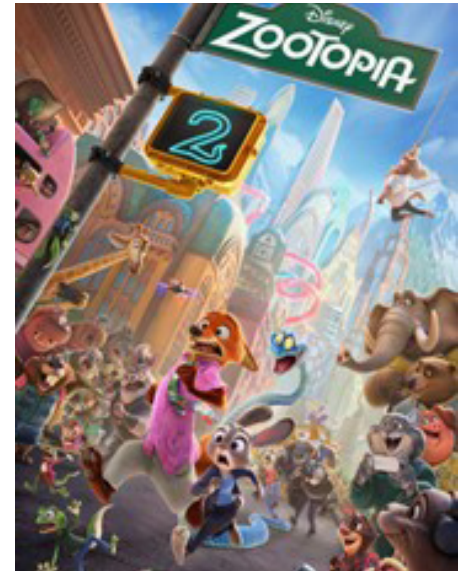
action adaptation of *How to Train Your Dragon* captured the hearts of audiences of all ages with its fantastical world, powerful music, and emotional story. The visual design of the dragons and the reinterpretation of the story made it one of the most memorable cinematic experiences of 2025.



With the arrival of summer, the superhero wave returned. *Superman*, one of the most iconic characters of the DC universe, appeared in 2025 with

a completely new narrative. The film was highly praised both for portraying the human side of the character in depth and for its large-scale action sequences. Around the same period, the *F1* film brought the thrilling world of motorsports to the big screen, powerfully exploring themes of speed, competition, and success. The film became one of the year's surprises, especially for viewers interested in sports cinema. Throughout the summer, movie theaters were packed with action, comedy, romance, and horror films; productions catering to every taste proved just how rich 2025 was for cinema.

By autumn, the year's momentum showed no signs of slowing down. Edgar Wright's *The Running Man* became one of the most discussed films of the year with its dystopian world, striking visual language, and sharp social critiques. The film not only entertained audiences but also made them think, offering commentary on modern society, media, and power relations. In the winter months, the cinema world seemed to go out with a bang, presenting major productions. *Avatar: Fire and Ash* became one of the biggest events of 2025 with its extraordinary visual effects, detailed universe design, and epic story. The film once again demonstrated the power that technology brings to cinematic storytelling. Meanwhile, *Zootopia 2* marked a new milestone in the world of animation; with its multi-layered narrative appealing to both children and adults, it became one of the year's most beloved films.



In addition, the influence of digital platforms reached an unprecedented level in 2025. Many major films were released simultaneously for both theatrical and digital audiences. This accelerated the transformation of the cinema industry while offering viewers a wider range of options. On the independent film side,

productions like *Marty Supreme*, *Sinners*, and *Weapons* stood out as the year's most valuable art films due to their original narratives and strong performances, attracting significant attention at international festivals.

In conclusion, 2025 was a year in which action, fantasy worlds,

superhero mythology, animation, dramatic storytelling, and artistic experiments all blended together, leaving a lasting impact on cinema history both commercially and culturally. If cinema is one of the most powerful art forms reflecting the spirit of an era, 2025 was undoubtedly one of the years that most clearly captured that spirit.

Literature in 2025: An Exciting Year

by Yonca Turuşlar (11A)

The year 2025 stood out in the literary world for both its productivity and reader interest.

The books published this year were particularly centered around themes exploring the inner world of the individual, the chaos of modern life, and human relationships.

Among the most popular works in the novel category, *The Silent Sky* explored human loneliness and the search for hope with profound language, while *Ashes of Tomorrow* presented a pessimistic yet thought-provoking dystopian vision of the future. In the crime genre, books such as *The Last*

Witness and *Black Harbor* reached a wide readership with their gripping plots and unexpected endings. In young adult literature, *Moonfall Academy* and *Crimson Notes* became popular among young readers by addressing themes of identity and friendship.

In poetry and essay collections, themes of love, loneliness, technology, and social critique came to the forefront. Through these works, 2025 once again demonstrated that literature is not only a source of entertainment but also a force that provokes thought and reflection.





Shifting Balances in World Sports in 2025

by *Fatih Selçuk*

The year 2025 stood out as a year in which sports were no longer just a field of competition but became deeply intertwined with the economy, politics, and technology. Discussions focused less on the battles on the field and more on how sports were managed and who was directing them.

One of the most notable developments of the year was the further centralization of the global sports economy. Income gaps deepened in many sports, especially football. While large clubs and leagues grew financially stronger, medium and smaller structures struggled to stay afloat. Sports increasingly became associated not with competition, but with debates about “sustainability.”

In football, 2025 was a year in which the calendar crisis became clearly noticeable. The increase in

the number of clubs, leagues, and international tournaments directly affected player health. Injuries rose due to excessive match loads, and players and coaches began voicing objections more loudly. Player unions, for the first time, gained visibly significant influence.

For women’s sports, 2025 was seen as a year that confirmed lasting growth. Women’s football, basketball, and tennis saw significant increases both in audience size and sponsorship. However, it was also clearly evident that this growth had still not reached equal footing with men’s sports.

The relationship between technology and sports reached a new level in 2025. AI-supported performance analyses, referee decision support systems, and data-driven training methods became standard. At the same time,

criticisms that technologies like VAR were disrupting the nature of the game continued. The debate of “justice or flow?” became a central topic in the sports public sphere.

On a global scale, the intersection of sports and politics also became more visible in 2025. Athletes took clearer stances on wars, human rights violations, and environmental issues. While these statements were supported in some countries, athletes faced direct pressure in others. The claim that “sports are independent of politics” did not hold in practice.

2025 was also a year in which sports investments centered in the Middle East and Asia continued unabated. With new leagues, tournaments, and club acquisitions, the center of gravity in sports shifted away from the West. This development transformed the global structure of



sports while raising debates about ethics and competitive balance.

In conclusion, 2025 was a year in which structural issues were

discussed more than victories, and questions about the future of the game increased. While sports remained a powerful force uniting masses, it entered a search for a

new balance under the pressures of commerce, politics, and technology. The results of this search will become clearer in the coming years.

AI in 2025: From Technology to Social Force

by *Fatih Selçuk*

The year 2025 stood out as the year when artificial intelligence (AI) ceased to be merely a technology category and became an economic, legal, and social infrastructure element. The debate shifted from “What can AI do?” to “On whose behalf and how is AI shaping life?”



The most notable development of the year was the institutionalization of generative AI. Systems that produce text, images, audio, and video became standard tools not only for individual users but also for companies, government agencies, and educational institutions. AI was no longer just a supportive software; it was used directly as an integrated element in decision-making processes.

The relationship between AI and labor changed significantly in 2025. While productivity increased in some professions, human labor was pushed to the background in fields such as content creation, translation, customer service, and data analysis. Layoffs began to be carried out directly on the grounds of “automation.” This development made the impact of AI on employment a concrete reality rather than a theoretical discussion.

From a technical perspective, multimodal AI systems became widespread. Text, audio, images, and data analysis were combined into a single system. AI evolved into not just a responder but an entity capable of contextual understanding, task planning, and managing long-term processes. At the same time, how these systems made decisions became increasingly opaque.

2025 was also a year when AI regulations gained momentum. Many countries attempted to limit AI usage along ethical, legal, and security lines. Deepfake content, election security, the use of personal data, and copyright issues were among the most prominent topics. However, regulations struggled to keep pace with the speed of

technological development.

In education, AI reached an irreversible point in 2025. Personalized learning assistants for students became widespread, and traditional systems for homework, exams, and assessment began to be seriously questioned. The question “Is the student producing, or is it AI?” became one of the core crises for educational institutions.

In healthcare, defense, and security, AI’s approach to critical decision-making mechanisms became the most controversial development. Diagnostic systems, risk analyses, and surveillance technologies spread rapidly, raising the question of who is responsible when errors occur.

In conclusion, 2025 was the year when AI stopped being a controlled innovation and became a force affecting society as a whole. The main issue is no longer how advanced AI has become but who wields this power, within what limits, and for whose benefit. A clear answer to this question has not yet emerged, and the debate is expected to intensify in the coming years.



School Trips & Activities at ICS in 2025

Photograph Gallery



**Thank you for reading,
and supporting the ICS
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